



Department of Economics
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February 18, 2026

Search Committee
Department of Economics
Indiana University Bloomington
Bloomington, IN

Dear Members of the Search Committee,

I am writing to apply for the Visiting Assistant Professor position in Macroeconomics at Indiana University Bloomington. I am a Ph.D. candidate in the Department of Economics at Johns Hopkins University (advisors: Christopher D. Carroll, Nicholas W. Papageorge, and Stelios Fourakis), and I expect to receive my degree in May 2026. My primary specializations are macroeconomic modeling, wealth and income dynamics, and computational economics. I am committed to high quality instruction and active participation in departmental intellectual life.

My research agenda focuses on the ability of macroeconomic models to generate empirically realistic distributions of wealth and income over the life cycle. A key driver of that work is modeling heterogeneity in the rate of return on assets, and understanding how return dispersion contributes to portfolio accumulation across households.

In my job market paper, I calibrate a life cycle heterogeneous agent model to match wealth moments from the Survey of Consumer Finances by allowing households to differ in their portfolio returns. The model helps explain observed wealth concentration and return dispersion. In a related research project using the Health and Retirement Study, I examine how trust influences both income growth and asset returns. I find a hump shaped relationship for trust and returns (consistent with the literature) and characterize the distribution of the persistent component of returns to net worth. These experiences have equipped me to frame research strategies and design modeling approaches, execute econometric and simulation analysis with large micro data sets, and translate results into clear and rigorous written deliverables for both academic and practitioner audiences.

I am enthusiastic about teaching both undergraduate and graduate courses in macroeconomics. My research in heterogeneous agent macroeconomics provides a strong foundation for courses in intermediate macroeconomics, advanced macroeconomic theory, and macro finance. I enjoy helping students connect formal models to contemporary economic issues, including inequality, asset markets, and fiscal and monetary policy. In a two course per semester teaching load, I would aim to deliver rigorous and engaging instruction while contributing to seminars and collaborative discussions within the department.

Indiana University Bloomington's strong research environment and vibrant macroeconomics community make it an especially attractive setting. I would welcome the opportunity to engage fully in the in person academic environment in Bloomington and to contribute to the department's teaching and intellectual activities during the 2026–2027 academic year.

I believe I would be a strong fit for this role because:

1. My specialization in macroeconomics aligns directly with the department's teaching needs.
2. I am committed to delivering clear, rigorous, and engaging instruction at both undergraduate and graduate levels.
3. I value collaborative academic environments and active participation in departmental research life.

Thank you very much for your consideration. I would welcome the opportunity to contribute to the Department of Economics at Indiana University Bloomington.

Sincerely,

Decory Edwards